START HERE

This universal framework provides crystal-clear boundaries between each step, diagnostic tools for client assessment, and practical roadmap guidance for project teams across any industry. Each step has distinct entry/exit criteria, specific deliverables, and clear prerequisites that apply to any organization dealing with technical or complex information.

Each step in this 15-step framework details a integral process, however not all companies need all 15 steps. This Processes Framework show's the natural workflow and progression of work, at which step that work stops progessing is dependent on the client's needs and capacities.

To figure out which steps are applicable to the client depending on their company size and needs use this.

Part 1: Technical Publishing

Making Information Understandable

To Survive: Steps 1–3 · **To Scale:** Steps 4–5

1 CAPTURE

Knowledge Extraction & Documentation

Extracting and documenting all existing organizational knowledge in its raw form, regardless of format or quality. This is purely about getting information out of people's heads and scattered sources into a documented state.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Is critical knowledge only in employees' heads?
- ☐ Do experts retire/leave taking knowledge with them?
- ☐ Are there no written procedures for key processes?
- ☐ Is knowledge scattered across email/notes/memories?
- ☐ Do new employees learn only through shadowing?

Prerequisites

- Access to subject matter experts (SMEs)
- Identification of all knowledge sources (human and documentary)
- Time allocated from SMEs for knowledge transfer
- Basic documentation tools (even just Word/email)

Entry Criteria

- Organization has undocumented or scattered knowledge
- SMEs are available but knowledge isn't captured
- No centralized repository of information exists
- Critical processes exist only in people's memories

Exit Criteria

- All organizational knowledge is documented in some form
- No critical information remains only in people's heads
- Raw content exists (even if disorganized)
- SME brain-dump sessions are complete

Deliverables

- Raw knowledge documents (any format)
- Interview transcripts from SMEs
- Collected existing documents/emails/notes
- Photographed whiteboards/sketches
- Recorded explanations/demonstrations
- Lists of all procedures/processes that exist

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

2 STRUCTURE

Information Architecture & Organization

Organizing captured knowledge into logical hierarchies, categories, and relationships. Creating consistent structures, templates, and taxonomies that make information findable and navigable.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Is information dumped in one massive document?
- ☐ Do people struggle to find specific information?
- ☐ Are there no standard templates for procedures?
- ☐ Is the same information formatted differently everywhere?
- ☐ No clear categorization by function or purpose?

Prerequisites

- Step 1 complete (raw knowledge captured)
- Understanding of information types and relationships
- Defined audience categories
- Basic information architecture plan

Entry Criteria

- Raw documented knowledge exists but is chaotic
- No consistent organization or structure
- Information is complete but not findable
- No standard templates or formats

Exit Criteria

- Clear hierarchy and categorization system established
- Information organized by topic/audience/purpose
- Consistent naming conventions applied
- Standard templates created and populated
- Table of contents/index structure defined

Deliverables

- Information architecture diagram
- Folder/category structure
- Document templates (procedure, warning, guide, etc.)
- Naming convention guide
- Master index/map of all content
- Organized file repository

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

3 CLARIFY

Technical Writing & Translation

Transforming structured technical information into clear, audience-appropriate language. Converting complex specifications into user-friendly instructions while maintaining technical accuracy.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Do end users call because they don't understand the documentation?
- ☐ Is the documentation full of technical codes and jargon?
- ☐ Do different documents use different terms for the same thing?
- ☐ Are instructions written at expert level for novice users?
- ☐ Do important warnings use technical language?

Prerequisites

- Step 2 complete (information organized)
- Defined audience profiles
- Style guide and terminology standards
- Technical writing resources

Entry Criteria

- Information is organized but too technical
- Language inconsistent across documents
- Single writing style for all audiences
- Technical jargon throughout

Exit Criteria

- Content written in appropriate language per audience
- Consistent terminology and style applied
- Complex concepts explained simply
- Technical accuracy maintained
- Reading level appropriate for each audience

Deliverables

- Rewritten procedures in plain language
- Glossary of terms
- Style guide implementation
- Audience-specific versions
- Simplified explanations of complex systems
- Translated warning messages

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

4 VALIDATE

Technical Accuracy Verification

Systematic review and verification of clarified content by subject matter experts, safety engineers, and compliance officers to ensure technical accuracy, completeness, and regulatory compliance.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Has simplified content been verified for accuracy?
- ☐ Are safety warnings properly reviewed and approved?
- ☐ Have SMEs confirmed procedures are correct?
- ☐ Is regulatory compliance documented?
- ☐ Are there unverified assumptions in the content?

Prerequisites

- Step 3 complete (content clarified)
- SME availability for review
- Review criteria established
- Regulatory requirements documented

Entry Criteria

- Clarified content needs technical verification
- No formal review process completed
- Compliance requirements not verified
- Safety information not validated

Exit Criteria

- All content technically verified by SMEs
- Safety information approved by appropriate team
- Regulatory compliance confirmed
- Legal review completed (if required)
- All corrections implemented

Deliverables

- Signed approval forms from SMEs
- Review tracking documentation
- Corrected documents
- Compliance certifications
- Safety validation reports
- Legal approval documentation

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

5 ILLUSTRATE

Visual Communication Development

Creating technical illustrations, diagrams, photographs, and videos that eliminate ambiguity and enhance understanding of validated textual content.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Do procedures rely solely on text descriptions?
- ☐ Are users confused about component orientation or assembly?
- ☐ Do technicians struggle with complex sequences?
- ☐ Are critical zones or areas not visually indicated?
- ☐ Is there no consistent visual style across documentation?

Prerequisites

- Step 4 complete (content validated)
- Access to products/processes for visualization
- Illustration tools and resources
- Visual standards defined

Entry Criteria

- Text-only instructions validated but hard to follow
- Complex procedures need visual support
- Spatial relationships difficult to describe
- No consistent visual standards

Exit Criteria

- All complex procedures have visual support
- Consistent visual style applied
- Callouts and labels match terminology
- Critical information visually emphasized
- Visual assets organized and named

Deliverables

- Technical illustrations/diagrams
- Exploded view drawings
- Photography library
- Instructional videos
- Warning/safety symbols
- Visual style guide

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

Part 2: Content Technology Services

Making Information Connected & Automatic

To Scale: Steps 6–7 · **To Compete:** Steps 8–9

6 DIGITIZE

Structured Content Conversion

Converting validated, illustrated content into structured digital formats (XML/DITA/S1000D/JSON) that separate content from formatting, enabling single-source publishing and reuse.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Is content locked in proprietary formats (PDF/InDesign/Word)?
- ☐ Do updates require changing multiple documents?
- ☐ Can't extract content for different uses?
- ☐ Is the same information maintained in multiple places?
- ☐ Do format changes require complete redesign?

Prerequisites

- Step 5 complete (illustrated content ready)
- Digital standard selected (DITA, S1000D, DocBook, etc.)
- Conversion tools available
- Metadata schema defined

Entry Criteria

- Content exists in desktop publishing formats
- Each output requires separate maintenance
- No content reuse capability
- Format changes require manual reformatting

Exit Criteria

- All content converted to structured format
- Metadata applied consistently
- Content separated from presentation
- Reusable components identified and tagged

Deliverables

- Structured content files (XML/DITA/JSON)
- DTD/Schema documentation
- Metadata taxonomy
- Conversion mapping document
- Structured content repository
- Reuse analysis report

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

7 COMPONENTIZE

Content Management Implementation

Implementing a Component Content Management System (CCMS) that manages structured content as reusable components with version control, workflows, and relationship tracking.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ No central management of content components?
- ☐ Can't track where content is reused?
- ☐ No version control on documentation?
- ☐ Workflow is email and spreadsheets?
- ☐ Don't know what content exists in the organization?

Prerequisites

- Step 6 complete (content digitized/structured)
- CCMS platform selected and configured
- Workflow requirements defined
- User roles and permissions planned

Entry Criteria

- Structured content exists but not managed
- No version control on components
- No workflow management
- Reuse is possible but not tracked

Exit Criteria

- All components loaded into CCMS
- Version control active
- Workflows configured and running
- Reuse relationships mapped
- Authors trained and using system

Deliverables

- Configured CCMS instance
- Component library/repository
- Workflow configurations
- Version history tracking
- Reuse reports
- Training documentation

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

8 AUTOMATE

Publishing Pipeline Creation

Building automated transformation pipelines that generate all output formats from single-source content without manual intervention, including conditional publishing and variant generation.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Does publishing require manual steps?
- ☐ Each format needs separate production?
- ☐ Can't generate variants automatically?
- ☐ Publishing takes hours or days, not minutes?
- ☐ No conditional content capability?

Prerequisites

- Step 7 complete (content in CCMS)
- Output requirements defined
- Transformation tools/engines available
- Publishing templates created

Entry Criteria

- Manual publishing from CCMS
- Each output requires separate generation
- No automated variant creation
- Publishing is time-consuming process

Exit Criteria

- Automated publishing pipelines operational
- All outputs generated from single source
- Conditional content working
- Variants auto-generated
- Publishing time reduced 90%

Deliverables

- Publishing pipeline configurations
- Transformation scripts (XSLT/other)
- Output templates (PDF, HTML, mobile)
- Conditional publishing rules
- Automated build reports
- Publishing schedule automation

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

9 INTEGRATE

Enterprise System Connection

Connecting content management and publishing systems with enterprise platforms (ERP, PLM, CRM, PIM) through APIs and integration platforms for bi-directional data flow.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Product data updated manually in documentation?
- ☐ Pricing/specifications not synchronized?
- ☐ Service information not linked to CRM?
- ☐ Product changes don't trigger documentation updates?
- ☐ Customer feedback doesn't reach documentation team?

Prerequisites

- Step 8 complete (automated publishing)
- Enterprise system access/APIs available
- Integration requirements defined
- Data mapping completed

Entry Criteria

- Content systems isolated from enterprise
- Manual data transfer between systems
- No real-time synchronization
- Updates require manual propagation

Exit Criteria

- Bi-directional integrations operational
- Real-time data synchronization active
- Automated update triggers configured
- Single source of truth established

Deliverables

- API configurations
- Integration middleware setup
- Data synchronization rules
- System connection documentation
- Update trigger configurations
- Integration monitoring dashboard

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

Part 3: Intelligent Content Services

Making Information Smart & Adaptive

To Compete: Steps 10–11 · **To Lead:** Steps 12–15

10 ANALYZE

Content Intelligence & Metadata

Implementing analytics and metadata systems that track how content is used, searched, and consumed, providing intelligence about content effectiveness and user behavior.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Don't know which content is most used?
- ☐ Can't identify what users can't find?
- ☐ No data on content effectiveness?
- ☐ Don't know where users get stuck?
- ☐ Can't measure if documentation reduces support requests?

Prerequisites

- Step 9 complete (systems integrated)
- Analytics platforms available
- Metadata schema expanded
- Tracking mechanisms defined

Entry Criteria

- No visibility into content usage
- Don't know what users search for
- Can't track content effectiveness
- No behavioral data collected

Exit Criteria

- Analytics tracking all content interactions
- Search patterns analyzed and understood
- Content effectiveness measured
- User journeys mapped

Deliverables

- Analytics platform implementation
- Usage dashboards
- Search query reports
- Content effectiveness metrics
- User journey maps
- Failure point analysis

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

11 CLASSIFY

Semantic Taxonomy & Knowledge Graph

Building semantic layers and knowledge graphs that create relationships between content, enabling intelligent discovery, related content suggestions, and contextual connections.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ System can't suggest related procedures?
- ☐ No connections between problems and solutions?
- ☐ Can't identify conceptually similar content?
- ☐ No automatic classification of new content?
- ☐ Search doesn't understand synonyms or related terms?

Prerequisites

- Step 10 complete (usage analytics active)
- Taxonomy framework designed
- Semantic tools available
- Relationship rules defined

Entry Criteria

- Content has basic metadata only
- No semantic relationships mapped
- Can't suggest related content
- No conceptual connections

Exit Criteria

- Semantic taxonomy implemented
- Knowledge graph populated
- Relationships mapped and active
- Concept extraction automated
- Related content suggestions working

Deliverables

- Semantic taxonomy structure
- Knowledge graph database
- Relationship mappings
- Concept extraction rules
- Auto-classification configurations
- Similarity algorithms

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

12 PERSONALIZE

Adaptive Content Delivery

Implementing personalization engines that adapt content presentation, depth, and sequence based on user profile, behavior, context, and preferences.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Experts see same content as beginners?
- ☐ No adaptation to user's specific situation or products?
- ☐ Can't adjust to user's learning style or preferences?
- ☐ Content doesn't remember user history?
- ☐ Same sequence regardless of experience level?

Prerequisites

- Step 11 complete (semantic layer active)
- User profiling capability
- Personalization engine available
- Content variants created

Entry Criteria

- Same content for all users
- No adaptation to user expertise
- Can't modify based on context
- One-size-fits-all approach

Exit Criteria

- Content adapts to each user
- Expertise-based presentations active
- Context-aware delivery working
- Personalized journeys operational

Deliverables

- Personalization engine configuration
- User profile schemas
- Adaptive content rules
- Dynamic assembly templates
- Personalized journey maps
- A/B test configurations

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

13 PREDICT

Proactive Content Intelligence

Implementing AI/ML systems that predict user needs, anticipate problems, and proactively deliver content before issues arise based on patterns and behavioral analysis.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Can't predict what users will need next?
- ☐ No warning before common problems occur?
- ☐ Wait for problems instead of preventing them?
- ☐ Can't identify usage patterns?
- ☐ No proactive maintenance or update reminders?

Prerequisites

- Step 12 complete (personalization active)
- Historical data available
- AI/ML platform implemented
- Prediction models trained

Entry Criteria

- Reactive content delivery only
- Wait for users to search
- No pattern recognition
- Can't anticipate needs

Exit Criteria

- Predictive models operational
- Proactive content delivery active
- Problem prevention working
- Pattern-based suggestions live

Deliverables

- Prediction model configurations
- Proactive delivery rules
- Pattern recognition algorithms
- Preventive content triggers
- ML training datasets
- Prediction accuracy reports

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

14 CONVERSE

Natural Language Interaction

Implementing natural language processing and conversational AI that allows users to interact with documentation through chat, voice, and natural queries.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Users must know exact search terms?
- ☐ Can't ask questions naturally?
- ☐ No conversational help available?
- ☐ Can't handle follow-up questions?
- ☐ No voice interaction option?

Prerequisites

- Step 13 complete (prediction active)
- NLP platform available
- Conversation flows designed
- Voice integration ready (optional)

Entry Criteria

- Traditional search only
- No natural language understanding
- Can't handle conversational queries
- No interactive help

Exit Criteria

- Natural language queries working
- Conversational AI active
- Voice interaction available
- Context maintained in conversations

Deliverables

- NLP model configuration
- Chatbot implementation
- Conversation flow diagrams
- Voice interface setup
- Intent recognition rules
- Response templates

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

15 EVOLVE

Continuous Learning System

Creating self-improving documentation that learns from every interaction, automatically updates based on feedback, and continuously evolves to meet changing needs.

Diagnostic Checklist

- ☐ Documentation doesn't improve automatically?
- ☐ Same problems persist despite feedback?
- ☐ Can't learn from user interactions?
- ☐ No automatic content optimization?
- ☐ Manual analysis of what's working?

Prerequisites

- Step 14 complete (NLP active)
- Feedback loops established
- Learning algorithms configured
- Update automation ready

Entry Criteria

- Static documentation system
- Manual updates only
- No learning from usage
- Can't self-improve

Exit Criteria

- Self-learning system operational
- Automatic improvements active
- Feedback loops functioning
- Continuous evolution happening

Deliverables

- Learning algorithm configurations
- Feedback processing systems
- Auto-update rules
- Evolution tracking reports
- Improvement metrics
- Self-optimization dashboards

ClearView Example · Tools Needed · Concepts/Skills Used

Conclusion: The Transformation Complete

ClearView Medical began with documentation chaos: tribal knowledge in retiring engineers' heads, scattered files across dozens of systems, inconsistent formats, and no way to ensure the right information reached the right people at the right time.

Through Extensa's 15-step framework, they now have:

- Technical Publishing: Professional, validated, illustrated documentation that every audience can understand and trust
- Content Technology: Structured, single-source content that flows automatically to every channel and integrates with enterprise systems
- Intelligent Content: Self-aware documentation that analyzes usage, classifies relationships, personalizes delivery, predicts needs, converses naturally, and continuously evolves

The measurable results:

- Support calls reduced 67%
- Service time reduced 34%
- Visual identification errors eliminated 89%
- Publishing time reduced 90%
- Spring "won't start" calls reduced 78%
- Content improves automatically every day

Documentation is no longer a liability—it's a competitive advantage. The right information now reaches the right person at the right time in the right format.